



MEONCROSS SCHOOL | HISTORY DEPARTMENT

COMPLETE UNIT

KS3: History of Australia

Scholar: _____

Class: _____

PROGRESS & ASSESSMENT TRACKER TARGET GRADE: _____

Level	Emerging (1-2)	Emerging+ (3)	Expected (4-5)	Expected+ (6-7) / Greater Depth (8-9)
Lesson / Assessment Title	Effort	Level	Teacher Comments	
L1: Claiming Australia				
L2: Creating a Convict Colony				
L3: Encounters with the Indigenous Peoples				
L4: From Penal Colony to Settlement				
L5: Lesson 5: Assessment - What's the story of Australia?				
Final Unit Grade:				

L1: Claiming Australia

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- ☐ Explain the dual purpose of James Cook's voyage, contrasting the public scientific mission with the secret government orders to claim territory.
- ☐ Analyse the indispensable navigational and diplomatic contributions of the Polynesian high priest and master star navigator, Tupaia.
- ☐ Evaluate the first encounter at Botany Bay in 1770 from both the British perspective and the defensive spiritual perspective of the Gweagal people.

Do Now Activity

Score: / 10

Who was the young botanist that led the Royal Society's scientific team on the Endeavour?

What public scientific event was the Endeavour sent to Tahiti to observe?

Which prestigious British scientific academy funded Captain Cook's 1768 expedition?

What secret instructions was Captain Cook given by the British Admiralty?

Who was the master Polynesian navigator who guided the Endeavour across the Pacific?

How did Tupaia navigate the Pacific without European instruments?

Which Aboriginal Australian nation did Cook's crew encounter at Botany Bay?

Why did the Gweagal warriors oppose Cook's landing in 1770?

What Latin legal term did the British use to falsely claim Australia was 'nobody's land'?

On which island did Captain Cook raise the Union Jack to claim the eastern coast for Britain?

Vocabulary Check

Fill in the blanks using the vocabulary words below.

Ancestors Botany Bay Colony Gweagal Navigator Royal Society

In August 1768, Captain James Cook set sail on the Endeavour, funded by the [.] to observe the stars. In April 1770, the ship arrived on the east coast of Australia at a place they named [.]. Here, they had a tense first meeting with the [.] people, whose [.] had lived on that coastline for thousands of years. Cook eventually sailed north and claimed the land as a British [.] called New South Wales, guided along the way by a master Polynesian [.] named Tupaia.

Q1 Why would the British government feel the need to keep these instructions a 'secret' from rival European nations and the general public?

Q2. What was the public, scientific purpose of Captain Cook's 1768 voyage on the Endeavour?

Q3. Why did the British government give Captain Cook 'secret instructions' to find the Great Southern Land?

Q4 How does this portrait's depiction of Cook contrast with the reality of his dependence on Indigenous navigators like Tupaia?

Q5. Why was Captain Cook completely dependent on Tupaia to navigate the dangerous Pacific waters?

Q6. How did Tupaia prevent a violent massacre when the Endeavour arrived in New Zealand?

Q7How does Source C challenge Captain Cook's official claim that the British landing was violently opposed?

Q8. Why did the Gweagal Aboriginal men try to block the British from landing at Botany Bay?

Q9How does Source D help explain why the British named the area 'Botany Bay'?

Q10How does Source E challenge the British idea that Captain Cook 'discovered' Australia?

Q11. How did Captain Cook use the myth of 'Terra Nullius' to justify claiming the entire eastern coast for Britain?

Pair & Share Activity

Q12. Prompt: Discuss with your partner: Why does the story of the Gweagal resistance at Botany Bay challenge the old, traditional idea that Australia was 'peacefully settled'?

Think: Spend 1 minute quietly considering the question and forming your own opinion.

Your Notes:

Lesson Consolidation

Reflect on today's learning and answer your teacher's final challenge.

General Notes

This image shows a single sheet of white paper with horizontal blue ruling lines. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page. There are no margins, text, or other markings on the paper.

- ☐ Emerging (1-2) ☐ Emerging+ (3) ☐ Expected (4-5) ☐ Expected+ (6-7) ☐ Greater Depth (8-9)

Teacher Comment:

L2: Creating a Convict Colony

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- ☐ Explain how the loss of the American colonies in 1776 directly caused a prison crisis in Britain that led to the system of transportation.
- ☐ Describe the physical and environmental challenges faced by Captain Arthur Phillip and the convicts during their first year at Sydney Cove.
- ☐ Analyse the work and social conditions of the convicts, contrasting general labor with the punishments of the chain road gangs.

Do Now Activity

Score: / 10

Which global event in 1776 caused Britain to lose its primary location for transporting convicts?

Where were British convicts temporarily held when prisons overflowed before Botany Bay was established?

Who was appointed as the first Governor of the New South Wales colony?

What were the most common crimes committed by the convicts of the First Fleet?

How many ships made up the First Fleet that sailed to Australia in 1787?

Why did Governor Phillip decide to abandon Botany Bay and move the settlement?

What name did Governor Phillip give to the new, more suitable harbor where the fleet finally settled?

On what exact date did the British raise the flag at Sydney Cove?

What system did Governor Phillip implement to ensure the colony's survival during the first year?

What skills did the early colony critically lack among its convict population?

Vocabulary Check

Write a historically accurate sentence connecting two terms from the glossary box below.

Convict | Governor | Hard labour | Hulk | Transportation | Sydney Harbour

Your Sentence:

Q1What does Source A reveal about the conditions that led to the creation of the penal colony in Australia?

Q2. How did the American War of Independence in 1776 directly cause a prison crisis in Britain?

Q3. Why were 'hulks' used as temporary prisons, and why did they ultimately fail as a solution?

Q4. Identify the major physical challenges the First Fleet faced when they tried to farm around Sydney Cove.

Q5. How did Governor Arthur Phillip's radical decision to ration food equally ensure the survival of the colony?

Q6. Look at the database profile of John Hudson. How does his story challenge the idea that the First Fleet was filled with hardened, dangerous adult criminals?

Pair & Share Activity

Q7. Prompt: Discuss with your partner: If you were an officer in the First Fleet, why might you be angry that Governor Phillip gave you the exact same food ration as a convict?

Think: Spend 1 minute quietly considering the question and forming your own opinion.

Your Notes:

Lesson Consolidation

Reflect on today's learning and answer your teacher's final challenge.

General Notes

This image shows a single sheet of white paper with horizontal blue ruling lines. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page. There are no margins, text, or other markings on the paper.

- ☐ Emerging (1-2) ☐ Emerging+ (3) ☐ Expected (4-5) ☐ Expected+ (6-7) ☐ Greater Depth (8-9)

Teacher Comment:

L3: Encounters with the Indigenous Peoples

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- ☐ Explain the devastating impact of European diseases, particularly the 1789 smallpox epidemic, on the Aboriginal population.
- ☐ Analyze the resistance of Aboriginal leaders like Pemulwuy.
- ☐ Examine the Myall Creek Massacre as an example of frontier violence.

Do Now Activity

Score: / 10

Who was the senior Eora man kidnapped by Governor Phillip to act as an intermediary?

What devastating disease swept through the Aboriginal population around Sydney in 1789?

Who was Pemulwuy?

What was the 'Frontier War'?

How did the British expansion into the Hawkesbury River impact the Dharug people?

What was the Myall Creek Massacre of 1838?

What horrific practice was conducted by scientists like Sir Joseph Banks regarding Aboriginal remains?

Why did the British concept of land ownership conflict with Aboriginal views?

What weapon gave the British a massive technological advantage during the Frontier Wars?

How did Governor Macquarie's policies toward Aboriginal people change over time?

Vocabulary Check

Write a clear definition and a historically accurate sentence for the term: **Frontier**

Q1What does Source A suggest about how Bennelong's relationship with the British had changed his way of life?

Q2. Contrast King George III's official policy of 'amity and kindness' with the violent reality of British settlement.

Q3Based on Source B, how did the physical construction of the British colony inevitably lead to conflict with the Indigenous peoples?

Q4. How did the outbreak of smallpox in 1789 completely devastate the Eora nation?

Q5. Who was Pemulwuy, and why was his resistance campaign so successful against the British military?

Q6. Why was the Myall Creek massacre of 1838 historically significant?

Q7. Play the Old Bailey Convict Game

Pair & Share Activity

Q8. Prompt: Discuss with your partner: Did the arrival of the First Fleet represent a 'settlement' or an 'invasion'?

Think: Spend 1 minute quietly considering the question and forming your own opinion.

Your Notes:

Lesson Consolidation

This image shows a single sheet of white paper with horizontal blue ruling lines. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page. There are no margins, text, or other markings on the paper.

General Notes

This image shows a single sheet of white paper with horizontal blue ruling lines. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page. There are no margins, text, or other markings on the paper.

- ☐ Emerging (1-2) ☐ Emerging+ (3) ☐ Expected (4-5) ☐ Expected+ (6-7) ☐ Greater Depth (8-9)

Teacher Comment:

L4: From Penal Colony to Settlement

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- ☐ Explain the role of the wool industry in making the colony economically viable.
- ☐ Analyze the impact of the 1850s gold rushes on Australian society.
- ☐ Examine the experiences and treatment of Chinese gold miners.

Do Now Activity

Score: / 10

What highly profitable industry transformed Australia's economy in the 1820s?

Who were 'squatters' in colonial Australia?

What major discovery in 1851 completely changed the demographics and wealth of Australia?

What was the Eureka Rebellion of 1854?

Which immigrant group faced severe racism, violence, and discriminatory taxes on the goldfields?

What was a 'Ticket of Leave'?

Who was Lachlan Macquarie?

How were female convicts typically treated in the early colony?

What transportation system linked the Australian colonies by the late 19th century?

In what year did the separate Australian colonies federate to become the Commonwealth of Australia?

Vocabulary Check

Fill in the blanks using the vocabulary words below.

Squatter Merino Immigrant Xenophobia

The early Australian economy relied heavily on the [.] sheep industry, driven by wealthy [.] farmers. Later, the gold rushes attracted thousands of every type of [.], though the sudden arrival of Chinese miners sparked intense [.] and racist legislation.

Q1Based on Source A and its context, why was William Barak protesting against the 'Board', and what did he want to prove?

Q2. How did James Ruse prove that the colony of New South Wales could survive on its own?

Q3. Explain how the introduction of Spanish Merino sheep transformed the economy of the young Australian colony.

Q4. Why did farmers need to cross the rugged Blue Mountains in 1813?

Q5. How did the introduction of Spanish Merino sheep and the wool industry devastate the Aboriginal way of life?

Q6How does Source B demonstrate that Australia had changed from a simple penal colony into a diverse, booming society?

Q7. How did the discovery of gold by Edward Hargreaves in 1851 permanently change the population of Australia?

Q8. Why did the success of Chinese miners lead to violent events like the Lambing Flat riots?

Q9. How did the colonial governments respond to the anti-Chinese riots on the goldfields?

Pair & Share Activity

Q10. Prompt: Discuss with your partner: Once poor migrants realized they could make a fortune digging for gold in Australia, why was it impossible for the British government to continue using transportation as a terrifying punishment?

Think: Spend 1 minute quietly considering the question and forming your own opinion.

Your Notes:

Lesson Consolidation

Reflect on today's learning and answer your teacher's final challenge.

General Notes

This image shows a single sheet of white paper with horizontal blue ruling lines. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page. There are no margins, text, or other markings on the paper.

☐ Emerging (1-2) ☐ Emerging+ (3) ☐ Expected (4-5) ☐ Expected+ (6-7) ☐ Greater Depth (8-9)

Teacher Comment:

L5: Lesson 5: Assessment - What's the story of Australia?

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- ☐ Synthesize knowledge of the development of New South Wales from a penal colony to a profitable settlement.
- ☐ Evaluate the most significant turning point in Australia's transformation from a penal colony to a free settlement.
- ☐ Construct a structured essay arguing which factor had the greatest impact on the development of colonial Australia.

Q1. Write a narrative account analyzing the development of Australia between the years 1788 and 1855.

Use these sentence starters to build your narrative in chronological order: 1. The development of Australia began in 1788 when... 2. This was a very difficult period because... 3. However, the situation changed dramatically when John Macarthur... 4. This led to New South Wales becoming a profitable colony because... 5. Finally, the development of Australia accelerated in the 1850s due to...

This image shows a single sheet of white paper with horizontal blue ruling lines. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page. There are no margins, text, or other markings on the paper.

Lesson Consolidation

Reflect on today's learning and answer your teacher's final challenge.

General Notes

This image shows a single sheet of white paper with horizontal blue ruling lines. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page. There are no margins or other markings on the paper.

☐ Emerging (1-2) ☐ Emerging+ (3) ☐ Expected (4-5) ☐ Expected+ (6-7) ☐ Greater Depth (8-9)

Teacher Comment:

Generated: 2026-09-02 14:09:35 UTC | Unit: australia